



GREY BANNER ALERT



mainroads
WESTERN AUSTRALIA

SHW Serious Incident (SI) – Final Notice

Date of Incident	30 June 2023	Time of Incident	1145
Directorate / Region	IDD	Main Roads or Contractor	Contractor
EQSafe Event Type	Injury / Illness	EQSafe Incident Number	32387
Actual Consequence	Moderate	Potential Consequence	Major

Incident Short Description	Plate compactor fell whilst being lifted and contacted the dogman's safety helmet
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Executive Summary

On Friday 30 June 2023, at approximately 1145, a plate compactor fell onto a LV (light vehicle) when a 2t soft lifting sling became loose. This has caused the 500kg plate compactor, to fall from a height of approximately 1.5m to the ground at an angle. During the fall, the compactor hit the utility gate of the light vehicle, causing the arm of the compactor to strike the front left section of the head of the dogman (IP), who was standing in the line of fire.

The IP was wearing a hard hat, which cracked under the force resulting in the IP falling unconscious for approximately 20 seconds and a head wound. Emergency services were immediately contacted. A nearby worker who was not directly involved, in the activity provided initial first air assistance. The Supervision team, responded promptly, closed the scene, and reported the incident to WorkSafe. The IP was subsequently transported to hospital for a precautionary assessment. The IP was required to have 9 stitches, to the cut on his head. An x-ray indicated no fractures. The IP had a follow up medical appointment on 3 July 2023.

Management suspended all lifting operations involving any excavators across the project. Approval from Superintendents was required prior to recommencing operations.



The safety helmet was split from the contact of the handle of the plate compactor and the inside of the helmet has contacted the left-hand front of the dogman's scalp.



5 tonne Kubota excavator and the plate compactor.



The handle of the plate compactor has contacted the left-hand side of the dogman's safety helmet.

Contributing Factors

- The JHA in place for the task did not specifically address the lifting of a plate compactor.
- The lefthand drop tray panel was damaged (previously) and as such it was left in the up position.
- Not using the dedicated lifting point on the excavator.
- No shackle utilised to secure the sling to the lifting point.
- No tag line used.
- IP / Dogman did not follow project Safety Essentials for staying minimum 5 metres out of zone and using certified lifting equipment nor did the Dogman follow his training as a Dogman.

Corrective Actions

- Standard lift SWMs to be developed with the input of superintendent and site dogman that includes key elements completed on a daily basis that also targets plate compactors, steel plates, pit lids and relevant subcontractor work.
- Meeting held with all supervisors to discuss expectations around lifting practises that link into the PCBUs and what type of incidents need to be reported to Worksafe.
- Communications to be conducted onsite advising the importance of completed JHAs for specific tasks.
- Refresher JHA training to be undertaken for the dogman and excavator operator involved in this incident.
- Safety team to check all alliance owned lifting equipment is tagged correctly.
- Project alert to be developed for approval and circulation.

Additional Issues / Learnings**Critical Risk:**

This serious potential incident aligns with the Main Roads
Critical Risk Profile relating to **Dropped Objects and
Lifting Operations**

Distribution of Notice

Main Roads Personnel and Contracting Organisations